

Samuel Cole

> Founding engineer and CTO. I make things from scratch.

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§ EXPERIENCE

- 6
Lemontree
CTO
Transformed a NYC helpline serving a handful of people a day into a food-access system helping over a million people across 11 regions in 2025. Built an LLM pipeline (Gemini Flash) that 2.5×'d call volume for a 3-5-person team across Pakistan, the Philippines, and Kenya. Mentored an engineer; owned strategy, budget, and infrastructure.
2021 - Present
- 5
ActBlue
SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER
At the Democratic fundraising platform: rewrote the main donation-form server (Ruby Sinatra → Node; ops later lifted it to AWS unchanged) and the company's PCI tokenizer. Solo, built a new embed from scratch at 100% test coverage. Contributions scaled from ~\$1B to over \$8B. Embed powered the Biden presidential campaign, the NAACP, Everytown, and more.
2017 - 2021
- 4
Abacus
FULL-STACK ENGINEER
One of 5 engineers building tools for enterprises to manage employee spending. Shipped receipt view, a redesigned search and faceting system, automated flight metadata, and trip-level grouping. Acquired by Emburse.
2015 - 2017
- 3
Jukely
LEAD WEB ENGINEER
Employee #8 at a live-music subscription startup. Built the client-side app from scratch in React / webpack / Reflux; contributed to the Rails API, including the company's first Stripe integration. When the CEO announced a Canada launch a week out with no code written, shipped full-stack currency and localization, on time.
2014 - 2015
- 2
Kickstarter
SOFTWARE ENGINEER
Employee #12, one of the first two full-time engineers; joined pre-launch. Owned the client side as Kickstarter scaled from \$28M in annual pledges to crossing \$1B cumulative (March 2014), with 22,000+ projects funded in 2014 alone. Built the front-end of the multistep project editor (still the basic shape of today's flow), site search, custom text editors, creator messaging / backer tools, admin tooling, and the first mainstream HTML5 video player.
2010 - 2014
- 1
Patch
FRONT-END WEB ENGINEER
First front-end engineer; joined before the company had a name. Built the CMS and front-end architecture that scaled to hundreds of small-town news sites across America, plus a system for rendering highly customized neighborhood maps. Acquired by AOL.
2008 - 2010
- 0
Rochester Institute of Technology
B.S., MULTIDISCIPLINARY STUDIES
Computer Science & Literature; minor in Creative Writing.
2004 - 2008

§ SKILLS

LANGUAGES >
TypeScript · Node.js · Next.js · React · Ruby on Rails

INFRA & DATA >
Postgres · Prisma · Redis · AWS (RDS, ECS) · Vercel · GitHub Actions · ETL pipelines

APIS & AI >
Mapbox · Twilio · Google Cloud · Vertex AI (Gemini) · AI SDK · LLM agents